Cause and consequence sort cards

Friday 22 January 2027 | P2 | 40 minutes | Year A

Humanities | GROW | Spring 1 Week 3 | HUM-GROW-S1-W03

These cards are new factual teaching summaries, written in 2026. No old text, speech, testimony or picture is copied. A–H are the sort set. P1 is a process note to use beside the sort.

E New ways to travel

During the boycott, 1955–1956

Many people walked or shared car rides instead of using buses. Volunteers arranged lifts and raised funds. Staying off buses changed daily travel. Shared help also made it easier to keep the protest going.

Research basis: H1, H3, H5.

A An arrest

1 December 1955

Rosa Parks was arrested after refusing to give up her bus seat. Organisers called for people to stay off buses on 5 December. This event helped set off the boycott.

Research basis: H1.

G A model for later protests

After the boycott, in later years

The boycott showed how people could keep a joint protest going without using violence. Later rights campaigns could draw on that example. It was one influence among many.

Research basis: H1, H3.

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C Unfair bus rules

Before December 1955

Black passengers faced racist seating rules and unfair treatment on Montgomery buses. These problems had lasted for years. They gave people reasons to seek change.

Research basis: H1, H2.

H Fewer bus fares

During the boycott, 1955–1956

When many passengers stopped using buses, the bus company took in less fare money. This put pressure on the company. It did not, by itself, change the law.

Research basis: H5.

D Links that lasted

After the boycott, in later years

The campaign built links among people and groups working for civil rights. Those links helped support joint work beyond Montgomery in the years that followed.

Research basis: H3.

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F Earlier calls for change

1954, before the boycott

The Women's Political Council asked for fairer bus treatment before 1955. It made requests in 1954. Little changed. These problems gave people a reason to seek stronger action.

Research basis: H1, H2.

B A change to bus seating

20–21 December 1956

After the court order reached Montgomery, the boycott ended on 20 December. People returned to buses on 21 December with the old seating rule removed. The legal case helped secure this change.

Research basis: H1, H4.

P1 A legal case alongside the protest

5 June and 13 November 1956

Four Black women continued the court case Browder v. Gayle. Federal judges ruled against bus segregation on 5 June. The US Supreme Court upheld the ruling on 13 November. The order reached Montgomery in December.

P1 is not a ninth sort card. Link this legal process to card B. Refusing bus travel did not itself overturn the law.

Research basis: H4.